

prior to making an investment so that there are no surprises for the investor.

Keeping Track of the ICOs

Numerous online sites list new ICOs and other resources to keep tabs on current and future ones.¹⁸ Smith + Crown is a well-respected firm that's positioning itself as an information source for the ICO world. It provides an updated list of current, past, and upcoming ICO sales.¹⁹ Other resources include ICO Countdown²⁰ and Cyber-Fund.²¹ CoinFund also operates a great Slack community, with dozens of threads, many of which are dedicated to conversations about the specifics of upcoming ICOs.

Criticism of the ICO Model

Daniel Krawisz of the Satoshi Institute²² considers ICOs “snake oil” and “pump and dump scams.”²³ Pavel Kravchenko, founder of Distributed Lab, questions if we “really need all of these coins” and advises, “Let’s think for a moment before participating in an ICO — could the same technology solve the same problems without the coin?”²⁴ While some ICOs can be from misleading asset issuers or seem “Ponzi-like,” innovative investors have the resources provided in Chapter 11 to help them avoid such schemes. Others will scream that an ICO is a scam simply because they disagree with the funding model, as can be common with some Bitcoin Maximalists.